

water of the northern Adriatic. We felt welcome and were told that Americans can retire there with ease.

We returned to Buenos Aires in late 1986 to write and enjoy our third summer as retirees. Summer is vacation time for us. I said in chapter 2 that one concern about retiring was that I might never enjoy a vacation again. What do I have to vacate from? But our retired lives have settled into a rhythm. When in Buenos Aires we read, write, go to parties, talk with friends, linger over coffee, take walks, play the sax, sing in a choir, go to museums or zoos, watch TV, and go to plays. When summer comes we're ready to break that rhythm. We're ready to flop on the beach and enjoy vacations as much as ever.

In February 1987, we moved to Mexico's Yucatán peninsula for two months. Vicki and I are both interested in history and anthropology. We climbed through Mayan ruins and fantasized about living there fifteen hundred years ago. We decided to try to volunteer for an archaeological dig, probably somewhere in Mexico or Central America.

When we plan trips, Vicki and I both make sure we have our own reasons for going. Vicki's reasons may coincide with mine: watching bullfights in Spain, relaxing on the beach in Punta del Este, or crawling around ruins in the Yucatán. But she also pursues her own interests. For example, Vicki does energy-balancing massages and sound healing. While I was in Boston at Berklee, she learned new techniques in the Cambridge Healing Resource Center.

MY FRIEND SAM

My two mentors—the two who taught me most about retiring young—are Sam and Nick. Their stories help illustrate what to do and not to do during retirement's first few years.

You heard about Sam in chapter 1. He taught me the \$50-a-Day Rule. He was 42 years old and chief financial